Project Report – Cybercrime Awareness

While researching UPI and QR code fraud for this module, I was most surprised by the power of Social Engineering. I previously assumed that cybercrime always involved complex hacking or malware, but I learned that scammers often rely on simple psychological triggers like urgency and the excitement of a scholarship to bypass a student's common sense. It was eye-opening to see how easily a tech savvy individual can be tricked into entering a PIN if they are distracted or pressured by a countdown timer.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is how I interact with QR codes and unsolicited links. I have decided to never scan a QR code for receiving money, and I will verify the identity of any sender via a phone call before clicking on financial links. As a Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal, I now feel more responsible for reminding my peers that a PIN is strictly for sending money, which is a simple but vital rule for staying safe online.